

Fullstack Development

Preflight Project - Database

[Github Repo](#)

Prerequisite

- Docker
 - Docker desktop
- Database management tools
 - Dbeaver

Popularity

- SO Survey 2025

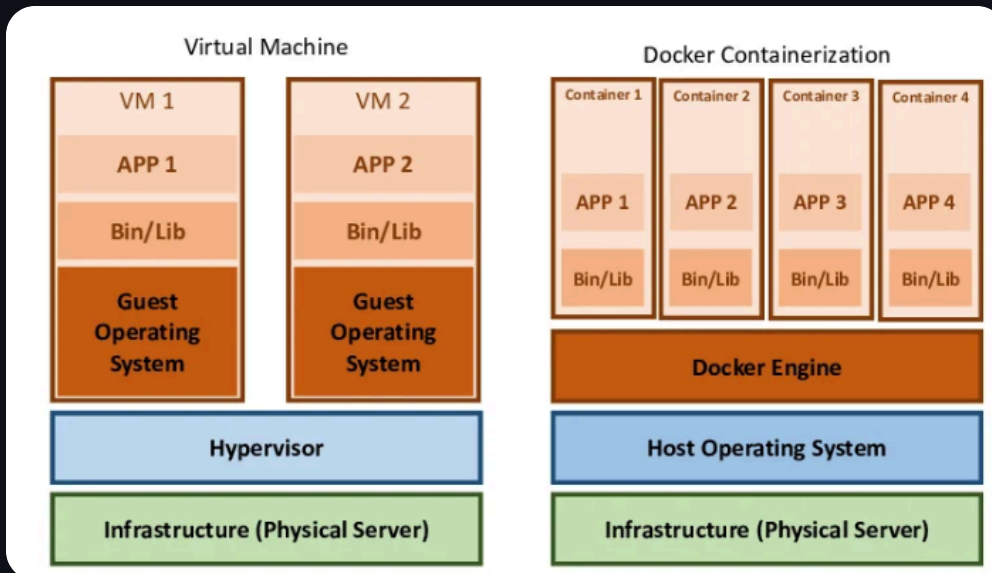
Choices

- Relational database
 - PostgreSQL / MariaDB / MySQL / SQLite
- NoSQL
 - Types
 - Vendors

Docker 101

Containers

Provide a way of creating an isolated environment in which applications and their dependencies can live.



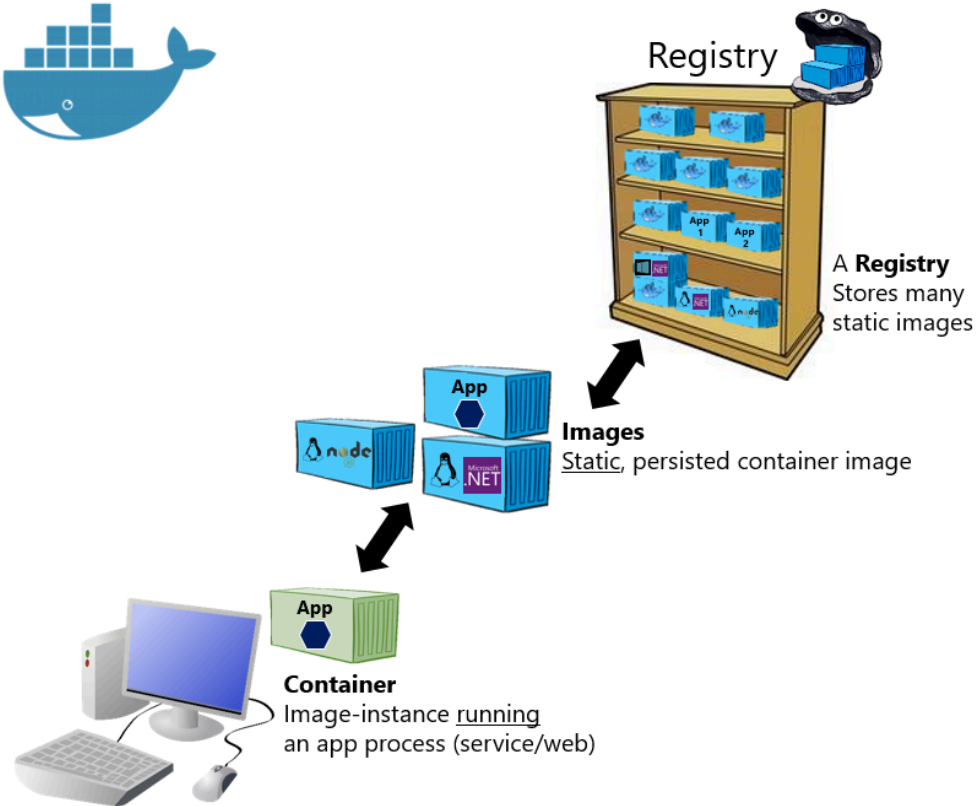
Why containers?

- Portability (save container to registry or even USB)
- Consistency (works everywhere)
- Easy deployment (can test on local machine)
- More efficient (than virtual machines).

Docker

- A containerization platform
 - Leading player
- Alternative `Podman`

Basic taxonomy in Docker



Hosted Docker Registry

Docker Trusted Registry on-prem.

On-premises
(‘n’ private organizations)

Docker Hub Registry

Docker Trusted Registry on-cloud

Azure Container Registry

AWS Container Registry

Google Container Registry

Quay Registry

Other Cloud

Public Cloud
(specific vendors)

Should you run database on docker container?

| It depends.

Spinning up database instance

- Files

-  `./.env` Copy from [here](#).

-  `./.gitignore` [\(link\)](#)

-  `./docker-compose.yml` [\(link\)](#)

-  `./_entrypoint/init.sh` [\(link\)](#)

- *Windows: Make sure that you save with LF option. [\(What?\)](#)*

- *Mac:* `chmod +x ./_entrypoint/init.sh`

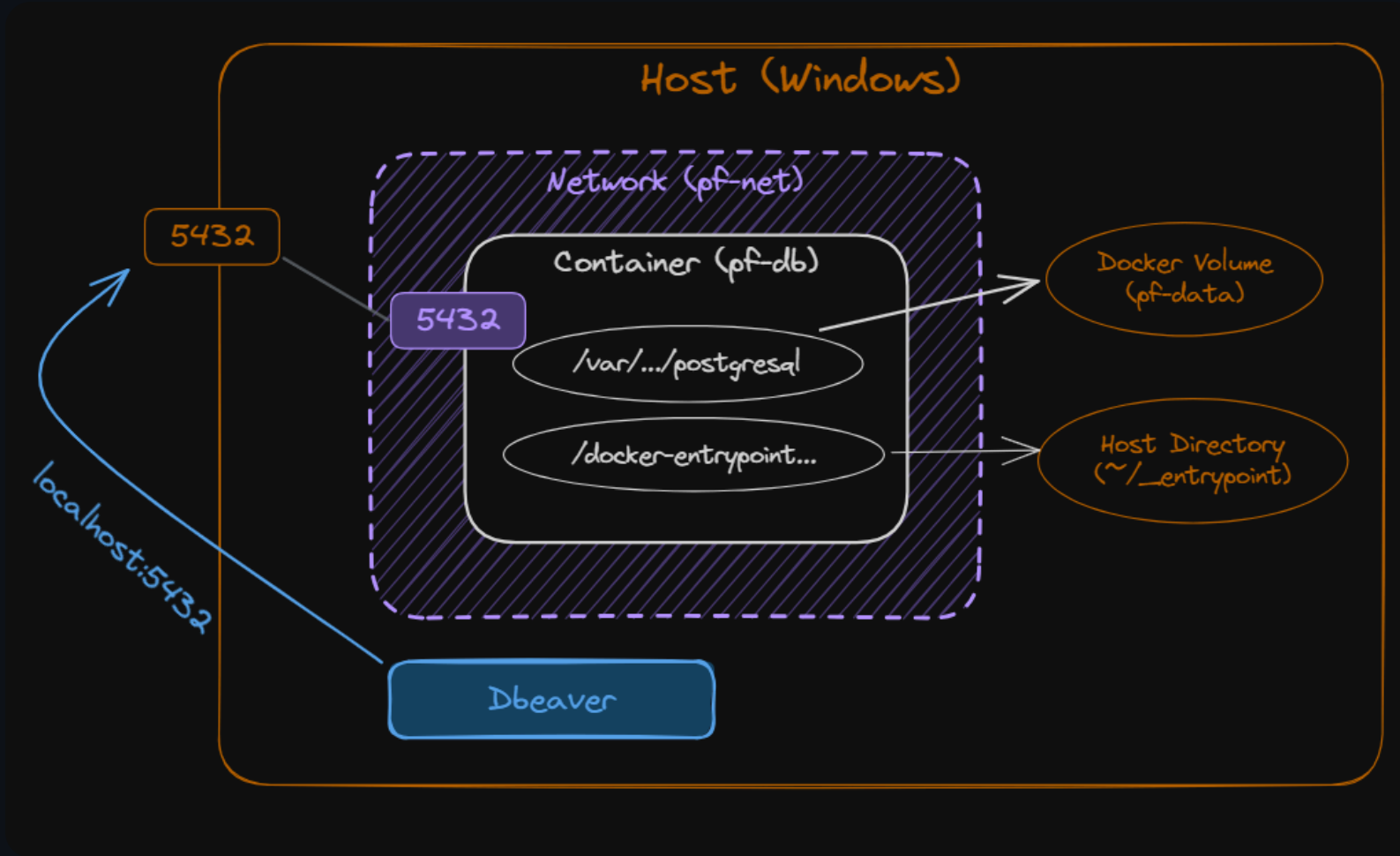
-  `docker compose up -d`

Note on Docker Commands

- `docker compose up -d` to start the container in detached mode.
- `docker compose down` to stop the container.
 - `docker compose down -v` to remove the volume as well. (Careful, you will lose all data in the database.)
- `docker compose restart` to restart the container.
- `docker compose logs -f` to view the logs of the container.
- `docker compose exec pf-db bash` to enter the db container.

Note on Docker Commands

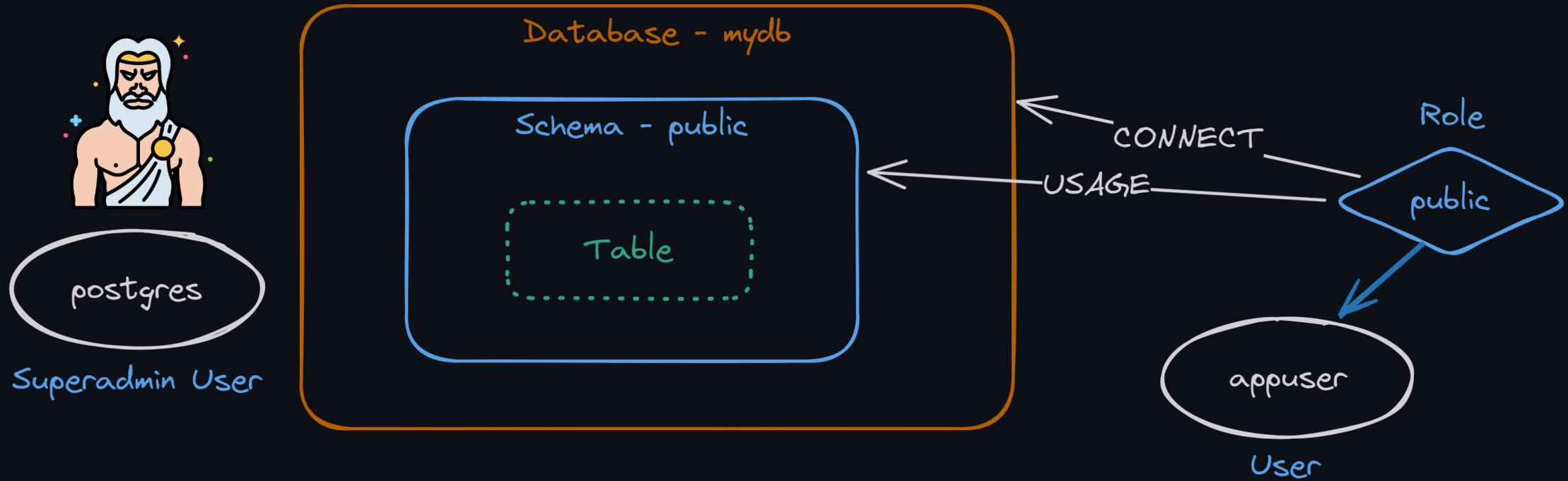
- `docker volume ls` to list all volumes.
- `docker volume prune` to remove all unused volumes.
- `docker network ls` to list all networks.
- `docker network prune` to remove all unused networks.

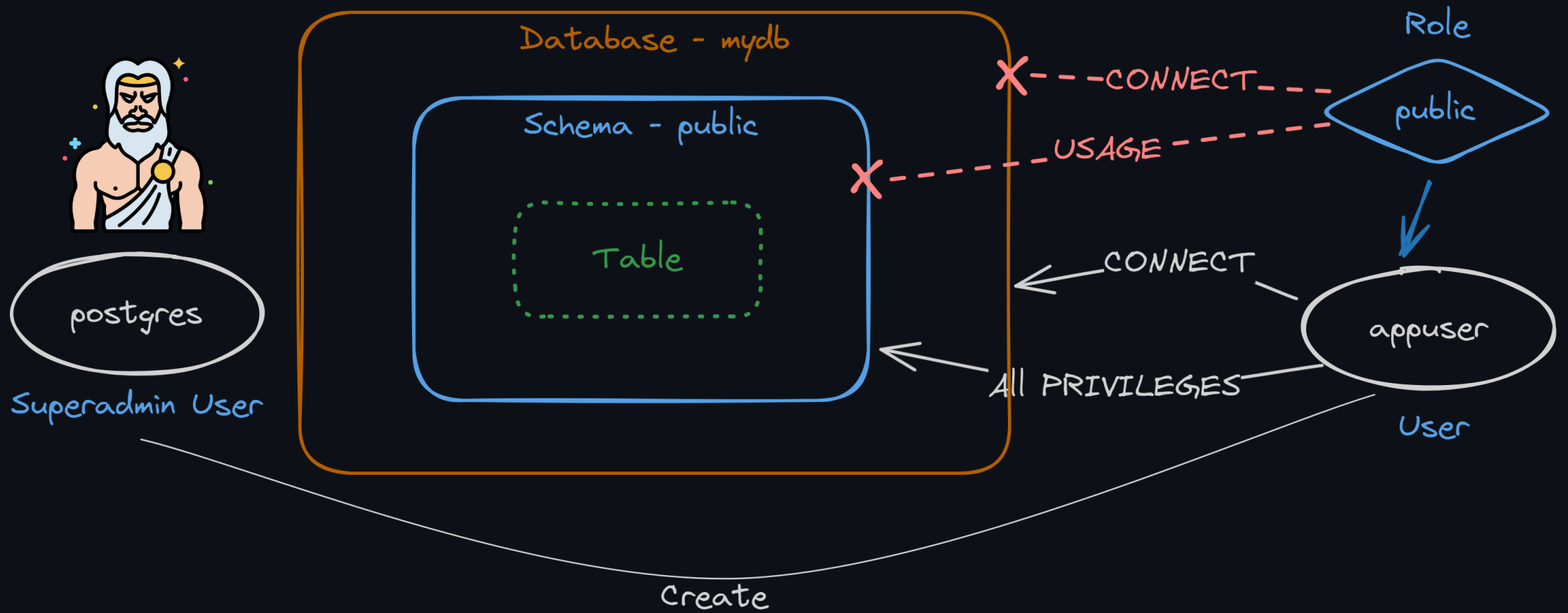


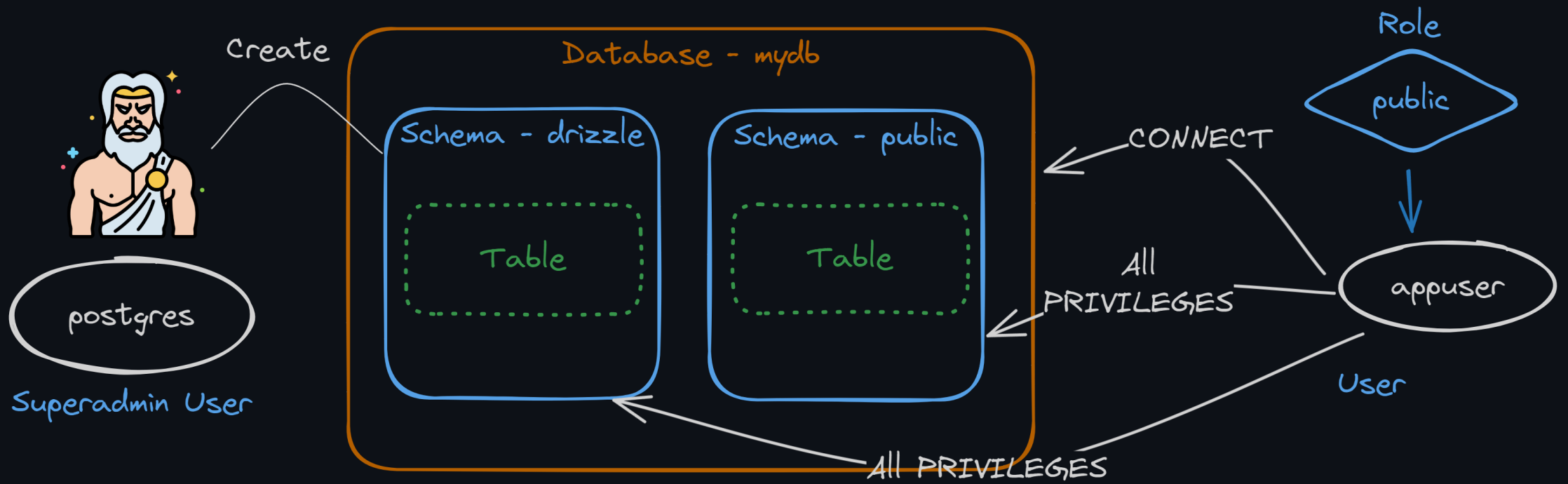
Note on PostgreSQL 18

- Breaking change: the internal container volume mount path
 - `/var/lib/postgresql/data` -> `/var/lib/postgresql`
- Why?
 - Previously, mounting directly to the `data` folder made major database upgrades difficult.
 - In PostgreSQL 18+, the container automatically creates a version-specific subdirectory (like `/var/lib/postgresql/18/docker`).
 - This allows using `pg_upgrade --link` when migrating to future versions (like PostgreSQL 19), because multiple version directories can now live inside the same host volume mount.

Database User Management



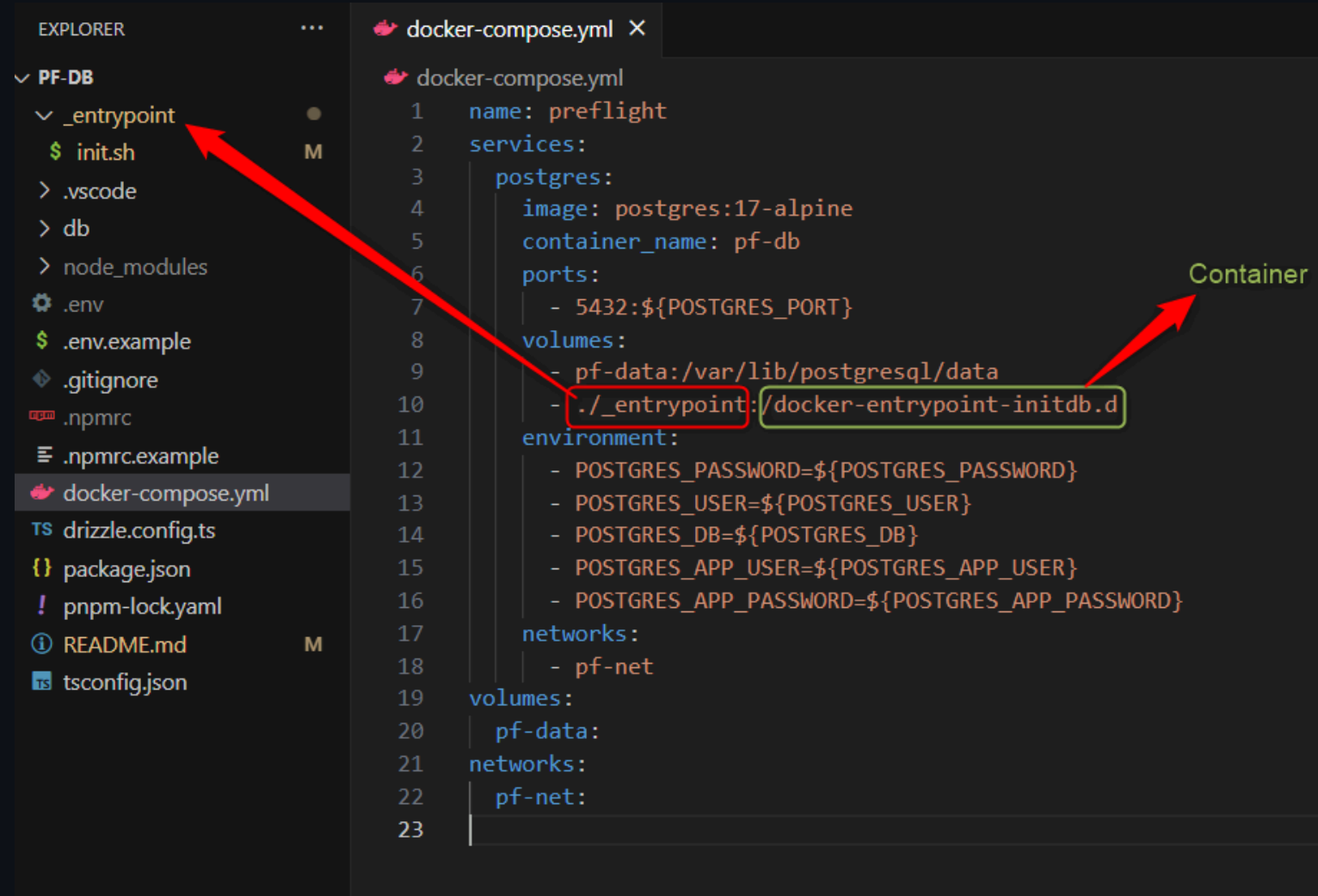




- We want to execute this when a postgres container is freshly created.
(Not restarted)

```
REVOKE CONNECT ON DATABASE mydb FROM public;  
REVOKE ALL ON SCHEMA public FROM PUBLIC;  
CREATE USER appuser WITH PASSWORD '1234';  
CREATE SCHEMA drizzle;  
GRANT ALL ON DATABASE mydb TO appuser;  
GRANT ALL ON SCHEMA public TO appuser;  
GRANT ALL ON SCHEMA drizzle TO appuser;
```

Any script files in `_entrypoint` will be executed automatically, when a docker container is freshly created. (Not restarted)



Manual DB User Management

| No longer needed

- `docker compose exec pf-db bash` (or `docker exec -it pf-db bash`)
- `psql -U postgres -d mydb`
 - Note that you do not need to input password here due to how the image is [setup](#). (See section in `POSTGRES_PASSWORD`)
- Don't forget to change the password for `appuser`.

```
REVOKE CONNECT ON DATABASE mydb FROM public;
REVOKE ALL ON SCHEMA public FROM PUBLIC;
CREATE USER appuser WITH PASSWORD '1234';
CREATE SCHEMA drizzle;
GRANT ALL ON DATABASE mydb TO appuser;
GRANT ALL ON SCHEMA public TO appuser;
GRANT ALL ON SCHEMA drizzle TO appuser;
```

Note on `psql`

- `\l` to list all databases
- `\du` to list users
- `\dn` to list schema
- `\dt` to list tables
- `\c` to view connected database or change to another db.
- `\q` to quit

ORM

- Object Relational Mapper
- A piece of software designed to translate between the data representations used by databases and those used in programming (in our case, Typescript).

Why ORM?

- Get type information when interacting with database.
- Write schema file
 - Good for documentation
- Nice Tooling
 - Database synchronization
 - Schema generation from existing database
 - Database viewer
 - Migration tool

Should you use ORM?

| It depends.

JavaScript / TypeScript ORM

- Ranking

Setting up Drizzle

- `pnpm init`
- `pnpm install dotenv drizzle-orm postgres`
- `pnpm install -D drizzle-kit typescript tsc-alias tsx @types/node @tsconfig/node-lts @tsconfig/node-ts eol-converter-cli`
- `pnpm approve-builds`

Main Packages

- `drizzle-orm` - The ORM itself
- `drizzle-kit` - CLI tool for database synchronization and migration
- `postgres` - Node.js Postgres client

Other Packages

- `dotenv` - Load environment variables from `.env` file
- `tsc-alias` - A tool to replace path aliases in compiled JavaScript files
- `tsx` - A tool to run TypeScript files directly
- `eol-converter-cli` - A tool to convert line endings in files

./tsconfig.json

```
{
  "extends": [
    "@tsconfig/node-lts/tsconfig.json",
    "@tsconfig/node-ts/tsconfig.json"
  ],
  "compilerOptions": {
    "types": ["node"],
    "rootDir": ".",
    "outDir": "./dist",
    "paths": {
      "@db/*": [".db/*"]
    }
  },
  "include": [".db/**/*", "drizzle.config.ts"]
}
```


Database initialization

- Files
 -  `./db/utils.ts` [\(Link\)](#)
 -  `./db/schema.ts` [\(Link\)](#)
 -  `./drizzle.config.ts` [\(Link\)](#)

Database initialization

package.json

```
{
  "scripts": {
    "db:generate": "drizzle-kit generate",
    "db:push": "drizzle-kit push",
    "db:migrate": "drizzle-kit migrate",
    "db:prototype": "tsx ./db/prototype.ts",
    "build": "tsc && tsc-alias",
    "eol": "eolConverter _entrypoint/*.sh"
  }
}
```

Database synchronization

-  `pnpm run db:push`

Database migration

- Migration is like a *version control*.
 - Why do we need it since we already have database schema?
- Migrations ensures that database schema changes are tracked and reversible.

Migration

-  `pnpm run db:generate`
-  `pnpm run db:migrate`

Side note

- Migration rollback is not yet [available officially](#). (June 2026)
- You can try [drizzle-rollback](#).

CRUD

-  `./db/client.ts` ([Link](#))
-  `./db/prototype.ts` ([Link](#))
- `pnpm run db:prototype`
 - Note that you cannot use `node` to run `./db/prototype.ts` since it uses alias.

Build

- `pnpm run build`
 - Notice that `tsc-alias` will replace the alias with relative path in the compiled JavaScript files.
- `node dist/db/prototype.js`